

ZHL Productivity Pack

A productivity toolkit for Zillow Home Loans loan officers

AT FULL ADOPTION

~60 FTE

of LO time projected to be returned to selling and serving borrowers per year — once the toolkit is rolled out across the full LO base (~125,000 LO-hours / year).

MEASURED TO DATE

1,000 hrs

of real time savings in the first ~10 days of telemetry — roughly 100 LO hours given back every single day at today's voluntary adoption.

THE NUMBERS

Measured today. Significant headroom tomorrow.

Every tool reports a "time saved" measurement when it completes a task. The figures below are real telemetry, not estimates — collected over the first ten days of measurement, at the extension's current voluntary adoption level.

1,000

LO-hours saved (first ~10 days)

Direct measurement from in-extension telemetry.
About 100 hours of LO time returned every day.

~25,000

LO-hours / year at current adoption

Annualizing the measured run-rate on business days.
Roughly **12 FTEs** of LO time returned to selling and serving borrowers.

~125,000

LO-hours / year at full adoption

Projection if the toolkit is rolled out across the full LO base — roughly **~60 FTEs** of recovered capacity.

30+

distinct LO workflows accelerated

From single-click calculators to cross-tab automations.
Each LO opts into the features they want.

WHAT IT WOULD COST TO BUILD INSIDE PRODUCT / ENGINEERING

Initial build — 30+ shipped features, infrastructure (background service, telemetry, distribution), compliance posture, Chrome Web Store presence

~\$500K – \$750K

Ongoing maintenance & new feature pipeline — ~0.5 engineer + design / PM overhead, fully loaded

~\$150K – \$200K / yr

Internal build estimate: ~1.5 engineer-years of fully-loaded Product / Engineering capacity to deliver the equivalent feature set, plus ongoing capacity to maintain and extend it. Figures reflect typical fully-loaded ZG engineering rates (salary, benefits, overhead, PM / design / QA partnership). The time-savings numbers above are sums of conservative per-tool estimates against real telemetry — they track measured usage, not marketing projections, and adoption is still climbing.

What the time savings are worth in real dollars.

Converting the time and capacity figures into the language senior leadership thinks in. Numbers below reflect the full-adoption projection (~125,000 LO-hours / year, ~60 FTEs of recovered capacity).

RECURRING · ANNUAL

~\$12.5M

LO capacity returned to the business / year

~125,000 LO-hours per year at a conservative \$100/hr fully-loaded LO opportunity cost. Every LO-hour given back to selling, calling borrowers, and serving the existing pipeline rather than re-keying data or assembling documents.

ONE-TIME

\$500K – \$750K

Product / Engineering build cost avoided

~1.5 engineer-years of fully-loaded Product / Engineering capacity that did not have to be allocated to deliver the equivalent feature set. Capacity ZHL got to spend on its actual product roadmap instead.

RECURRING · ANNUAL

\$150K – \$200K

Product / Engineering maintenance cost avoided / year

~0.5 fully-loaded engineer of ongoing capacity to maintain, extend, and respond to LO requests — capacity that, again, is not being pulled off the formal product roadmap.

ONE-TIME

~\$6M – \$12.5M

Time-to-market acceleration value

The toolkit shipped via the LO-builder model in weeks, not the 12+ months a formal Product / Eng build cycle would have required. That delta represents up to a full year of LO capacity that ZHL did not have to forfeit while a build was in progress.

YEAR-ONE TOTAL POTENTIAL VALUE

~\$19M – \$26M

Combining recurring LO capacity returned, one-time build cost avoided, ongoing maintenance avoided, and the time-to-market acceleration already captured.

Methodology & assumptions. LO opportunity cost calibrated at \$100 / hour (fully loaded) — conservative for a revenue-generating LO at a mortgage lender; ZG's internal HR figure can be substituted. Product / Engineering build & maintenance estimates use typical fully-loaded ZG engineering rates (salary, benefits, overhead, PM / design / QA partnership). Time-to-market value reflects the LO capacity not lost during a counterfactual 12-month Product build cycle, sized between the measured current adoption and the projected full adoption.

ZHL Product & Engineering is already productizing the toolkit.

The strongest signal that this work is on the right roadmap isn't an LO endorsement — it's ZHL's own Product and Engineering teams adopting the toolkit's features as native LOP capabilities. The first one is already shipped.

DIRECT FROM PRODUCT & ENGINEERING

You've been our inspiration for getting some of your Chrome extension features built directly into LOP as supported product capabilities. Appreciate you pushing on these workflows — it's helping us turn your ideas into supported LOP features.

Melanie Gauriar — Senior Product Manager, ZHL

Ashley Green-Gluskin — Senior Manager, Product Management

Chris McBride — Senior Manager, Software Development Engineering

✓ First feature already shipped natively in LOP: drag-and-drop reordering for saved scenarios.

Every feature in the toolkit is a pre-validated, pre-loved spec.

LOs use them daily. Telemetry measures the impact. Product / Engineering inherits a battle-tested design rather than guessing at LO workflow needs.

The toolkit feeds the roadmap — it doesn't compete with it.

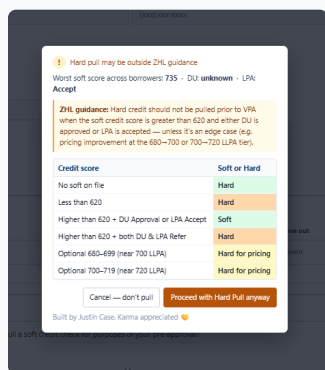
Native LOP shipping is the right long-term home for these features. The extension is where they're born, validated, and refined; the native rebuild is the durable destination.

Formalizing the LO-builder role keeps the pipeline flowing.

The Product team is building the first feature. There are 30+ more in the extension today and a backlog of LO-requested ones. The investment decision in front of leadership is whether to sustain the upstream supply of those specs.

What's already built — and what's next.

A selection of the active build pipeline. **Ready to ship** items are built and feature-flagged, awaiting a broad-rollout decision; **Scoped** items have clear DOM / data paths confirmed and could be in LO hands within days. Both Ready cards on this page came from inside-ZHL requests — the Hard Pull Guardrail from a Regional Manager via Wes, and Scenario Snapshot directly from App Support leadership.



READY TO SHIP · FEATURE-FLAGGED LIVE SCREENSHOT

Hard Pull Guardrail

Intercepts the Pull Credit click when Hard is selected and the soft score is greater than 620 with **DU Approval** or **LPA Accept** (outside the 680-719 LLPA pricing window). Confirmation dialog shows the full matrix + detected state. Not a hard stop — LO can Proceed Anyway with one click. The screenshot is the dialog firing live on a real loan (score 735, LPA Accept). Already running for the author's install; broader rollout pending leadership go-ahead.

READY TO SHIP · FEATURE-FLAGGED

Scenario Snapshot for App Support

When App Support gets a pricing-scenario ticket, they can't capture the full scenario card — it scrolls, so tickets arrive with partial screenshots and they bounce the LO for more. Adds a Snapshot button under every card that opens a one-viewport modal with every field, plus **Print** (PDF for ticket attachment) and **Copy as text** (drops fixed-column text into the ticket body). Direct ask from App Support; built same-day.

SCOPED

Pricing Exception Template Library

A per-LO library of saved exception templates (rate / point / lock-period combos) so repeat PE requests pre-fill the workflow form. Builds on top of the existing Pricing Exception Workflow tool.

SCOPED

Lock Extension Request Workflow

The PE-workflow pattern applied to lock extensions — guided checklist, auto-snip current pricing, assembled email to the lock desk in ZHL brand. Plugs into the same Encompass ZG# capture flow the PE tool already uses.

SCOPED

Multi-Borrower DTI Side-by-Side

An expanded view of the existing DTI Max Estimator that compares scenarios across two or more borrowers / income configurations on one screen — useful when a borrower is considering adding a co-borrower for qualifying purposes.

WHAT IT IS

A focused toolkit that lives where LOs already work.

A Chrome extension that runs *only* on the work systems LOs already use, and adds the small helpers, calculators, and one-click automations that remove friction from the highest-frequency LO workflows.

Lives inside existing systems

No new tools to learn. Buttons appear where the LO is already looking; calculators open inline; data copies between screens without re-keying.

Modular and individually toggleable

Every feature has its own on/off switch. Onboarding is a one-page Setup screen; LOs enable what helps them and ignore the rest.

Already in active use

Currently distributed to early-adopter LOs through the Chrome Web Store, with steady organic adoption as LOs share it with each other.

Built with compliance in mind

Borrower PII is stored locally on the LO's machine only, auto-expires in 24 hours, and is never transmitted externally. A formal data-flow document is available on request for IT / Data Compliance.

INSIDE THE TOOLKIT — 30+ TOOLS ACROSS SIX CATEGORIES

8 TOOLS

Calculators & Analyzers

VA Residual, VA Entitlement, 2-1 Buydown, Net Proceeds, DTI Max, FHA Flip Rule...

5 TOOLS

Cross-System Automations

Stage / Paste Borrower File, Add Co-Borrower to Salesforce, Caller ID, Auto Tab Switching...

5 TOOLS

UW Guardrails & Warnings

FHA Manual Analyzer, VA Manual Analyzer, FHA NPR Warning, VA Non-Spouse Warning...

4 TOOLS

Borrower-Facing PDFs

Loan Comparison PDF, 2% Grant PDF, Buyer Worksheet, Pricing Exception email assembly...

5 TOOLS

Document & Bulk Helpers

Bulk Task Download, ZillowDocs Bulk Download, Credit Report Reader, Address Copy...

5 TOOLS

Communication Shortcuts

SMS Quick-Add, SMS Mark All Read, Contact SMS, Gmail Caller ID, Gmail PE Paste...

RUNS ONLY ON:

LO Portal

Salesforce

Gmail

ZillowDocs

Genesys dialer

Slack

THE BIGGEST TIME-SAVERS

Where the hours come from.

A curated selection of the highest-impact tools — not the full inventory. Each one removes a recurring, manual step from the LO's day.



Stage from this file · Paste from staged

LO PORTAL

Copies a complete borrower record — including co-borrower, addresses, employment, declarations, and credit consent — from one loan file into another with a single click. Eliminates the entire re-keying cycle when an LO restarts an application or splits a co-borrower into a new file.

~10-15 minutes saved per use



VA Entitlement Calculator

LO PORTAL

Computes maximum no-down VA loan amount and the down payment required for any target loan amount, accounting for entitlement already used and county loan limits (2026 limits, including all high-cost counties, embedded directly). ZIP code is read from the file automatically and is editable.

~10 minutes saved per VA file



VA Residual Income Calculator

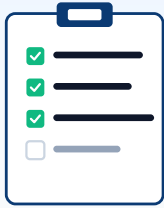
LO PORTAL

Computes VA residual income and shows pass / fail / borderline inline on the application form, accounting for family size, regional cost-of-living tables, and the 120% / 41% DTI threshold rules. Saves the LO from cross-referencing the VA tables manually.

~10 minutes saved per VA file

THE BIGGEST TIME-SAVERS (CONTINUED)

More of the highest-frequency wins.



FHA Manual · VA Manual Underwrite Analyzer

LO PORTAL

Breaks the manual UW checklist into checkable items, auto-detects AUS findings, embeds tooltips, and links to the ZHL matrix and the VA handbook Chapter 4. Switches presentation automatically when the loan file flips between FHA and VA.

~10 minutes saved per manual file



Pricing Exception Workflow

LO PORTAL

Auto-captures pricing scenarios, flags exceptions greater than 2.5 points, and assembles the pricing-exception request email in ZHL brand styling — ready to send. Removes screenshot-and-paste from one of the most paperwork-heavy LO workflows.

~15 minutes saved per exception



Caller ID — cross-system

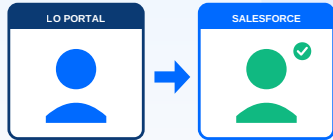
SALESFORCE · GMAIL · LO PORTAL · GENESYS DIALER

Shows who's calling — by name and matched lead — across every system the LO has open. Eliminates the manual "look up the phone number to figure out which borrower this is" step on every inbound call.

~2 minutes saved per inbound call

THE BIGGEST TIME-SAVERS (CONTINUED)

Cross-system automations and bulk operations.



Add Co-Borrower to Salesforce

LO PORTAL → SALESFORCE

Reads the co-borrower's name, phone, and email from the loan file, switches to the open Salesforce lead, opens New Contact, and fills the form — the LO just reviews and saves. Eliminates duplicate data entry and the fat-finger errors that come with it.

~3-5 minutes saved per co-borrower



Auto-Carry PA Contact ID on Lead Clone

SALESFORCE

When an LO clones an Unqualified Lead, Salesforce does *not* carry the PA Contact ID across — and missing it silently breaks the sync between the agent's FUB lead and the Salesforce lead. The toolkit now captures the ID at clone time, surfaces it on the confirmation modal, and auto-fills + saves it on the new lead. Sync stays intact without anyone having to remember.

~30-45 seconds saved per clone · sync break risk eliminated



Bulk Task Download · ZillowDocs Bulk Download

LO PORTAL · ZILLOWDOCS

Downloads multi-document task packages and credit reports in one click instead of clicking through each file individually. Particularly impactful during pre-approval document review.

~5-10 minutes saved per package



SMS Quick-Add · Mark All Read · Auto Tab Switching

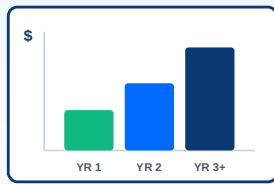
SALESFORCE

Adds participants to SMS threads in one click, marks all SMS threads read with one click, and auto-switches to the right Call Details / Messaging tab on inbound activity. A constellation of small tweaks that compound across an LO's day.

~3 minutes saved per inbound activity

THE BIGGEST TIME-SAVERS (CONTINUED)

Calculators & borrower-facing handouts.



2-1 Buydown Calculator

LO PORTAL

Computes year-1 and year-2 payment scenarios for 2-1 buydowns and renders them in a one-click handout for borrowers. Removes the spreadsheet step that used to be required for every buydown conversation.

~5 minutes saved per scenario

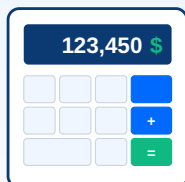


Loan Comparison PDF · 2% Grant PDF · Buyer Worksheet

LO PORTAL

One-click branded handouts for side-by-side loan comparisons, the 2% Grant program (gated to eligible Conf Home Ready / state / loan-amount combinations), and a print-ready scenario worksheet. Three borrower-facing artifacts that used to require manual document assembly.

~10 minutes saved per handout



Net Proceeds Calculator · DTI Max Estimator

LO PORTAL

Instant net-proceeds-from-sale math for refi and move-up scenarios, and a quick "what's the max purchase price" estimator. Both replace either a spreadsheet or a back-of-envelope calculation that the LO used to do mid-call.

~3-5 minutes saved per scenario

WHAT LOS & LEADERSHIP ARE SAYING

Voices from regional leadership — and across the LO base.

Four regional leaders (two SRMs, two RMs) on record, plus a representative sample from the 80+ karma notes that have come in from the broader LO base. Themes: time saved, errors avoided, manager-observed team-level efficiency gains, and the value of an LO building tools for other LOs.

SENIOR REGIONAL MANAGER

You need an App Support team for this.

— Wes Black

SENIOR REGIONAL MANAGER

Wow — that's incredible. In only a few weeks' time, too.

— Jack Christie

REGIONAL MANAGER

Seriously, we have an entire tech team and it took a super high-producing LO to get this done. I have no idea where you found the time.

— James Griesbach

REGIONAL MANAGER

Your Productivity Pack has been a game changer for LOs on my team — they are so much more efficient.

— MacKenzie Forster-Garcia

I love the VA residual income calculator you developed and freely shared with all of us. It would have kept me from a big blunder from a miscalculation on a VPA a couple of weeks ago. That won't happen again now.

— QUIN BERNHARDT, LOAN OFFICER

It has helped in so many ways. The residual income and student loan calculators are a real time save, and adding the loan officer to a group text with one click removes a possible compliance issue if the wrong phone number was selected.

— DAVID ALVAREZ, LOAN OFFICER

The Productivity Pack has probably saved me over an hour today — duplicating loans, running student loans, and sending out scenarios that I don't have to copy and paste the cost breakdown with. Love all of these tools.

— DUSTIN ENGLAND, LOAN OFFICER

The Productivity Pack has real LO time savers on clicks, calculations, and imports when navigating what seems like a spaghetti bowl of systems [SF → LOP → Enc]. Enhancements we have been asking for are final here.

— JOSH LEATHERMAN, LOAN OFFICER

More than just hours saved.

The time-saved number is the headline, but the real value of the toolkit is what those reclaimed hours let an LO do — and what they prevent from going wrong.

LOs spend more time selling.

Every workflow accelerated is a workflow that takes the LO away from a customer conversation, a referral follow-up, or a lead. The opportunity cost of LO time is not the LO's salary — it's the loans they would have closed.

Fewer hand-keying errors.

Borrower data copied programmatically between systems is data that wasn't fat-fingered. This shows up downstream as fewer corrections, fewer re-disclosures, and fewer support escalations.

Built-in guardrails on complex workflows.

Manual underwrite analyzers, VA / FHA warnings, and the residual-income chip enforce the right checks at the right moments. The LO doesn't have to remember to look something up — the toolkit prompts them.

LO morale and tenure.

LOs share the toolkit with each other and ask for new tools when they hit a friction point. That kind of organic adoption is itself a signal — this is the kind of internal tooling that makes LOs want to stay at ZHL.

Compliance posture is already clean.

Borrower PII never leaves the LO's machine. Usage telemetry contains no borrower data. A formal data-flow document is in IT's hands for review.